

Swimming

A reflection

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Preview edition

Chapter 1

Float

To swim first is to float.

Explain notes

- The water is there to help you to swim.

Chapter 2

Relax

Muscles that do not need to be used should be relaxed.

Chapter 3

Meditation

Swimming is meditation.

Chapter 4

Art

Swimming is an art.

Chapter 5

Observe

Observe before entering the water.

Explain notes

- At the beach, observe the waves.
- In a swimming pool, observe the spaces.

Chapter 6

Swim

Enter the water and swim.

Explain notes

- Where to enter is not affected by the observation.
- When to get out may be affected by whether able to swim there.

Chapter 7

Crowded

No matter how crowded, you can swim there.

Explain notes

- A crowded pool has space that keeps changing.
- When it is hard to swim there, get out.

Chapter 8

Shallow

No matter how shallow, you can swim there.

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Chapter 9

Goal

Swim without a solid goal.

Explain notes

- No time limit.
- No fixed distance.
- You can always come back tomorrow.

Chapter 10

Pool

Swim in the pool without bumping into others.

Chapter 11

Beach

Swim at the beach not affected by the wave.

Explain notes

- Wave make it fun.

Chapter 12

Steady

There is no swimming fast, but there is swimming steady.

Explain notes

- Do not swim to exhaust your body.
- The best swimming is like having not been swimming.

Chapter 13

Eyes

Should look at the bottom of the water.

Explain notes

- So your neck can be relaxed.
- Prepare for entering into meditation later.

Chapter 14

Suit

Wear a scuba diver suit and you can still swim at a good speed.

Explain notes

- It becomes part of your body.
- It makes you like a balloon, so you float more at the beach, therefore safer.

Chapter 15

Discipline

Swimming is discipline.

Explain notes

- If there is no discipline, you cannot swim.

Chapter 16

Change

Swimming is infinite change.

Chapter 17

Ideas

Swimming is the come and go of ideas.

Chapter 18

Fun

Swimming is about fun.

Explain notes

- Ideas make it fun.
- Can swim alongside others make it fun.

Chapter 19

Feel

Swimming is feeling what the water is like.

Explain notes

- After you feel what the water is like, you can bring the feeling out of the water, for example in speaking, walking, and so on.

Chapter 20

Habit

Swimming is a daily habit.

Explain notes

- It is not passion, because passion cannot be sustained.

Chapter 21

Routine

Wake up, brush teeth, go to swim.

Chapter 22

Don't compare

Do not compare with others.

Only compare with yourself.

Chapter 23

Don't stay alert

Better no need to stay alert than have to.

Explain notes

- When you stay alert, you cannot enter the flow state.
- You need to stay alert because you are too close to another swimmer, or because you have not found your way in the water.

Chapter 24

Mistake

*Do not swim longer than needed.
That will make the same mistakes longer.*

Chapter 25

Style

Follow the teachers at the beginning.

Later develop your own style.

Chapter 26

Freestyle

Choose freestyle.

Chapter 27

Breathing

Breathing on one side.

One breath every four strokes.

Chapter 28

Hands

Hands can pull back at any time.

Hands can push water to the sides.

The same hand can pull two times in a row.

Chapter 29

Head

Head can come out of the water and look to any side steadily.

Chapter 30

Legs

Legs can stretch out to keep balance.

Chapter 31

Knees

Knees can touch the bottom of the pool.

Chapter 32

Body

The body can tilt upwards.

The body can bend up in the middle.

Explain notes

- Both ways keep the head up, and you can see more above the water.

Chapter 33

Wave

*A hand can also be used to wave above the water
to greet a friend.*

Chapter 34

Toes

Toes can be used to push the lower body up.

Chapter 35

Movement

Movement can become so soft that you do not hurt yourself.

Chapter 36

Circles

Try to swim in small circles at the beach.

Chapter 37

Lane

In a swimming pool, you do not have to hold a lane.

Explain notes

- You can swim left or right and find your lane within the spaces.
- It will eventually be your lane when you follow the same path, even if it is not a straight line.

Chapter 38

Guard

*When you have to guard, guard with your hands
and leave some space.*

Chapter 39

Pass

When a faster swimmer is passing you, let them pass.

Explain notes

- Because you have triggered the passion within them.
- Keep your peace.

Chapter 40

Meditate

*Look at the bottom of the pool and enter into
meditation.*